From: Lowe, Claire (EGLE)
Sent: 1/10/2025 10:47:22 AM
To: "evenema@fveng.com" <evenema@fveng.com>; "utilities@cadillac-MI.net" <utilities@cadillac-mi.net>; "Patrick Miller" <pmiller@cadillac-mi.net>
Subject: Cadillac MAHL - December 2024
Attachments: Comments MAHL Dec 2024.docx

Good Morning,

I completed my review of the MAHL Report submitted in December. I believe many of the proposed limits are approvable. I have comments on the proposed limits for BOD, phosphorus, silver and phenol which are attached. I think most of these are easily resolved, with the possible exception of the phenol limit. Please let me know if you would like to discuss further. I should also get back to you on the manual review soon.

Thank you,

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CLEAN WATER ACT 50 YEARS

ATTACHMENT NAME:

Comments MAHL Dec 2024.docx

ATTACHMENT TYPE:

Microsoft Office 12+, Office Open XML (OOXML/OpenXML): document (DOCX)

Claire Lowe Comments – Cadillac MAHL December 2024

Industrial users

Page 3. Several SIUs were recategorized to non-SIUs. Please ensure that further explanation on why these were recategorized is included in the IPP annual report e.g. categorical discharge ceased, was incorrectly identified as a categorical process, flow decreased below SIU classification etc.

Phenols

Page 5, Table 2. The parameters identified include total phenols. The current approved local limit and WQBEL provided for this study are for phenol. EGLE does not recommend developing local limits for total phenols/total phenolic compounds as this is not a meaningful grouping in terms of toxicity or the behavior of the various pollutants. It is not clear based on the information provided whether samples collected out in the collection system for background concentration or within the WWTP to determine removal of pollutants were analyzed for phenol or for total phenolic compounds. Please clarify if analytical results can be/are provided for phenol alone. If results can't be provided for phenol it may not be possible to revise the phenol limit on the basis of the information currently available.

Silver

Page 13, Table 13. The MAIL after safety factor stated for Silver is given as 0.070 lbs/day based on the WQBEL for Chronic toxicity. This agrees with the calculations given in Table A6. If I complete this calculation, I make this result 0.0485 lbs/d. I don't know what the source of the discrepancy is for this. However, based on the proposed local limit for silver of 3 ug/L the limit is protective at both the above stated MAILs.

BOD

Page 15, Table 15. The % removal stated for BOD for June to September is 97.7%. This appears to be incorrect based on the MOR data provided with the first version of the MAHL study. The removal across the entire WWTP for June to September is stated as 97.6%, so this appears to have been incorrectly entered into the calculations. When the removal is adjusted to 97.6 the MAHL is reduced from 4366 lb/d to 4184 lbs/d and June to September. The resulting MAIL and local limits are reduced from 2710 to 2528 lbs/d and 400 mg/L to 353.7 mg/L, respectively.

Phosphorus

Page 6, Table 3. The table states the flow weighted average background samples for phosphorus is 6.3 mg/L. Based on the flow data provided on page 4, and background concentrations provided in appendix A, it appears the phosphorus flow-weighted average concentration should be 6.8 mg/L.

Page 17, Table 18 states that the phosphorus % removal for the period of May to March is 94.7%. The MOR data provided in the first version of the MAHL study does not provide an average for this period, but when calculated out based on the raw data this appears to be 94.5% removal. The resulting MAHL based on this removal is reduced from 135.3 lbs/d to 130.4 lbs.d.

Once the correction is made to the flow weighted average background concentration from 6.3 to 6.8 mg/L the background loading increases from 45 lbs/d to 49 lbs/d. The MAIL is therefore reduced from the 83 lbs/d, as stated in Section 5.5, Table 19, to 74.9 lbs/d and the resulting local limit once the safety factor is included is reduced from 11 mg/L to 10.5 mg/L.